



Book	Policy Manual
Section	BOARD POLICIES UNDER CONSIDERATION
Title	Copy of FAIR LABOR STANDARDS ACT (FLSA)
Code	po6700
Status	First Reading
Adopted	July 23, 2007
Last Revised	January 25, 2023

6700 - **FAIR LABOR STANDARDS ACT (FLSA)**

It is the Board of Education's policy to comply with the provisions of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and its implementing regulations. The Board shall pay at least the minimum wage required by the FLSA and Ohio law to all covered, non-exempt employees unless an employee's individual contract or the terms of an applicable collective bargaining agreement provide for greater benefits than mandated by Federal, State, or local law. ~~unless the terms of an applicable collective bargaining agreement provide for greater rights to its employees. To that end, the Board shall pay at least the minimum wage required by the FLSA to all covered, non-exempt employees.~~

Non-exempt employees are hourly employees, or salaried employees who do not qualify for a professional, administrative, executive, computer, or any other exemption under the FLSA.

Non-exempt employees who work (i.e., perform work on behalf of or for the benefit of the Board) more than forty (40) hours during a given work week will receive overtime pay in accordance with the FLSA for all hours worked in excess of forty (40). Work week is defined as the seven (7) day period of time beginning on Monday at 12:00 a.m. and continuing to the following Sunday at 11:59 p.m.

The Superintendent shall determine the necessity and availability of overtime work. Overtime may be authorized only by a supervisor and will be used primarily to address circumstances of an emergency or temporary nature. Non-exempt employees who work overtime without prior approval from the Superintendent or a supervisor may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Exempt employees are individuals who are exempt from the FLSA minimum wage and overtime provisions. These employees include, but are not limited to, persons employed in bona fide executive, administrative, and professional positions, and certain computer employees. To qualify for the exemption, employees generally must meet certain tests regarding their specific job duties and be paid a minimum per week salary as established by the Department of Labor. The salary requirement does not apply to teachers. Exempt computer employees must also meet a minimum per week or per hour salary established by the Department of Labor. Being paid on a "salary basis" means an employee regularly receives a predetermined amount of compensation each pay period on a weekly, or less frequent, basis. Additionally, the predetermined amount cannot be reduced because of variation in the quality or quantity of the employee's work. Subject to the exceptions listed below, an exempt employee must receive the full salary for any work week in which the employee performs any work, regardless of the number of days or hours worked.

Deductions may be made to an otherwise exempt employee's salary in certain circumstances without jeopardizing the employee's exempt status. Deductions may occur under the following circumstances:

- A. the employee is absent from work for one (1) or more full days for personal reasons other than sickness or disability

- B. the employee is absent from work for one (1) or more full days due to sickness or disability if the deduction is made in accordance with a bona fide plan, policy or practice of providing compensation for salary lost due to illness
- C. to offset amounts employees receive as jury or witness fees, or for military pay
- D. for unpaid disciplinary suspensions of one (1) or more full days imposed in good faith for workplace conduct rule infractions
- E. for penalties imposed in good faith for infractions of safety rules of major significance

In addition to the foregoing, exempt employees who accrue personal leave and sick leave may have their pay reduced or may be placed on unpaid leave for absences due to personal reasons of less than one (1) full day when leave is not used by the employee because:

- A. permission to use leave has not been sought or permission has been sought and denied;
- B. the employee's accrued leave has been exhausted; or
- C. the employee chooses to use leave without pay.

Deductions from an exempt employee's pay for absences due to a budget-required furlough shall not disqualify the employee from being paid on a salary basis except in the workweek in which the furlough occurs and for which the employee's pay is accordingly reduced.

The Board shall also not be required to pay the full salary in the initial or terminal week of employment if the employee does not work the entire week, or for weeks in which an exempt employee takes unpaid leave under the Family & Medical Leave Act.

The Board recognizes that with limited legally permissible exceptions as described, no deductions should be taken from the salaries of exempt employees. If an exempt employee believes that an improper deduction has been made to the exempt employee's salary, the employee should immediately report this information to the Treasurer/CFO or the employee's immediate supervisor. Reports of improper deductions will be promptly investigated. If it is determined that an improper deduction has occurred, the employee will be promptly reimbursed for any improper deduction made, and the Board will make a good faith commitment to avoid any recurrence of the error.

This policy shall be distributed to employees upon initial hire, and to all employees on an annual basis.

Reasonable Break Time for Nursing Mothers

As required by Federal law, the District shall take steps necessary to support staff members who decide to breastfeed their infants by providing additional unpaid reasonable break time, as necessary, for ~~a qualified employee~~ **an employee** to express breast milk for their nursing child for one (1) year after the child's birth on District premises.

Prior to returning to work from maternity leave, it shall be the employee's responsibility to notify their supervisor of their intent to continue breastfeeding their infant(s), and of their need to express milk during work hours. Further, it shall be the responsibility of the employee to keep their supervisor informed of their needs in this regard throughout the period of lactation.

The building administrator shall designate a private area, other than a restroom, where an employee can express breast milk. The designated area shall be a space where intrusion from coworkers, students, and the public shall be prevented, and one where an employee who is using this area can be shielded from view. **Employees who telework must also be free from observation by any employer-provided video systems, including video or security cameras or web conferencing platforms.**

The frequency and duration of breaks needed to express milk may vary. An employee will be responsible for informing the Principal or their supervisor of their needs as they change over time. The Principal or supervisor will work with the employee to adjust the employee's schedule and ensure that any required duties are covered. Employees shall be permitted to express milk during regularly scheduled break periods. The Principal or the employee's supervisor shall make adjustments in the employee's break schedule if the time of the regular breaks needs to be adjusted or if additional and/or longer breaks are needed. In the event that more breaks are needed or the break(s) need to be longer than the time available during a paid break, the additional time required shall be unpaid and the employee's work schedule or work day may be modified accordingly. An employee shall be enabled to express milk during regularly scheduled break periods. The Principal or employee's supervisor shall make an accommodation if the time of regular breaks needs to be adjusted or if additional and/or longer breaks are needed. In the event that more breaks are needed or the break(s) need to be longer than legally required, the additional time required shall be unpaid, and the employee's

~~work schedule or work day shall, therefore, be modified accordingly.~~ The Principal or the employee's supervisor shall work with the employee to make these necessary modifications.

Revised 6/26/17

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Legal 29 U.S.C. 201 et seq.
 29 C.F.R. Part 541
 R.C. Chapter 4111